



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/23

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

May/June 2022

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank pages for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

Text A: Permission to play: let's make fixing things cool again

This text is about encouraging people to repair their broken belongings.

Yellowed kitchen appliances, dusty record radios, unresponsive DVD players, the table was strewn with stuff that even a junk shop's disassemblers couldn't make anything. Most of the electronics were broken and all of them had outlived their usefulness. Maybe our grandparents would have had a go at fixing objects but the number of children that day, screwdrivers in hand, who crowded the table just to get a look inside this stuff, made me hope we could revive old skills

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The participants of the event were a little different from those I usually cater for at iFixit, a free online repair guide for everything from cracked mobile phones to oil changes for your car. My company's mission is to teach as many people as possible how to fix the stuff they own, kids included.

And kids were just as eager to learn as we were to teach them. The venue was crowded and noisy, but once they pried up the hood of a device, the world faded as pint-sized tinkerers were let loose on intricate circuit boards and motors. One teenager spent two hours working on an obsolete video player. It was amazing to watch the old relic whirr back to life.

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Kids are born tinkers: they like to fiddle with contraptions, experiment with 'What happens if?'. All they need is someone to put a device in one hand, a screwdriver in the other, and ask 'Do you want to take this apart?' and their eyes go wide with astonishment. After all, their parents have been telling them not to take things apart their entire lives

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As adults we enjoy our toys and gadgets too, though ours are more expensive so we keep them under wraps. Give kids something to take apart and their faces light up with excitement. Give adults the same device, and intimidation clouds their faces. That fear comes from a lifetime of feeling like electronics are beyond us and we're not qualified to tackle them. There are all kinds of pressures on us to replace rather than fix

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Text B: Can we fix it? The repair cafes waging war on throwaway culture

The following text is about the 'repair shop cafe' movement.

A vacuum cleaner, two laptops, an e-reader, a washing machine, hair clippers, three blenders, a pair of jeans and a remote-control helicopter. All broken.

It sounds like a pile of things that you'd find in boxes and take to the rubbish tip. In fact, it's a list of things mended in a single afternoon by eager volunteers in just one of the many repair shop cafes popping up.

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This repair cafe is part of a burgeoning international network aimed at confronting a world of 'stuff', of fridges and dishwashers littering dumps in countries far from where they were bought and the rubbish piling through the streets. There are now even TV programmes showing how treasured objects are restored and fixed.

The hair clippers belong to William, who describes himself as 'mechanically incompetent'. He sits down at the table of Christine who volunteers at the cafe, where people can bring household items to be fixed for free. In less than five minutes, Christine, a librarian, has unscrewed and removed the blades, cleaned inside the machine, oiled the blades and screwed it all back together.

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Today, the repairers will divert 24kg of waste from going to landfill. Some items can't be fixed on the spot but very little needs to be thrown away.

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Some volunteers are drawn to repair cafes to combat this 'throwaway culture'. The average lifespan for a piece of clothing in many countries is 3.3 years. In some countries it's less than that.

Manufacturers design products to break down after a certain amount of time, and make them difficult or expensive to fix. One repair cafe volunteer, Stuart Ward, explains 'Fixing items is actually discouraged by many manufacturers. We believe in the right to repair. You own your equipment; you should be allowed to take a screwdriver to it and play with it.'

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'Some repair cafes do the repair in front of the customer, not out in the back, not hidden,' says the lead IT technician in one repair cafe. 'It's a matter of confidence, not magic. Someone put it together, someone can take it apart.'

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Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

May/June 2022

2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Ink (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:
Set ion A: answer Question 1.
Set ion B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

Section A: Directed Writing

Question 1

The headteacher of your child's school is considering setting up a repair café run by volunteers in the school; the headteacher has asked for opinions from parents

Write a letter to the headteacher giving your views as a parent.

In ~~o~~ ur letter ~~o~~ u ~~s~~ ould:

- evaluate the ideas, attitudes and opinions given in the two texts
- give your views about whether or not a repair café is a good idea for students, staff and the wider community.

Base your article on what you have read in **both** texts but be a referee to use your own words
Address both of the bullet points

Write about 250 to 350 words

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of white paper designed for handwriting practice. It features 18 evenly spaced, horizontal dotted lines extending across the entire width of the page. The lines are thin and light gray, providing a guide for letter height and placement without being distracting. There is no text or other markings on the page.

[Total: 40]

[Turn to page 6 for Section B]

Section B: Composition

Answer **one** question from Set ion B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

EITHER

Descriptive writing

2 Describe a group of people meeting for the first time after a long separation.

OR

Descriptive writing

3 Describe a city street in very bad weather.

OR

Narrative writing

4 Write a story with the title, 'The prize'.

OR

Narrative writing

5 Write a story which involves having to correct a mistake.

Please write your best question number here (2, 3, 4, 5):

[illegible]

Blank lined paper for writing.

Blank handwriting practice paper with horizontal dotted lines.

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